PATIN / TERO!

Section 6 - Tournament Structure and Match Rules

Game Design Document | Reconstructed Draft v1.0 | For review before finalization

Section 6 defines the competitive tournament structure, matchmaking, match scoring, standings, elimination rules, and championship conditions. Eight participants compete in simultaneous offensive and defensive battles, accumulating points and adapting their rosters between rounds. The tournament follows **8 - 6 - 4 - 2 - 1** player progression. Unconfirmed numerical and procedural rules are identified as provisional.

6.1 Tournament Overview

A complete tournament begins with eight players. Each player builds runners and guards, prepares formations, and competes against one opponent each round. Matches use the deterministic simulation in Section 3. After designated rounds, lowest-ranked players are eliminated until one champion remains.

6.1.1 Tournament Objectives

- Reward consistent performance across matches.
- Encourage balanced offense and defense.
- Support strategic adaptation between opponents.
- Create tension through periodic elimination.
- Produce a single champion.

6.1.2 Tournament Format

Stage	Active players	Matches
Opening	8	4 simultaneous matches
First elimination	6	3 simultaneous matches
Second elimination	4	2 simultaneous matches
Finalists	2	Championship matchup
Champion	1	Winner declared

6.2 Tournament Entry and Initialization

A session begins when eight participants are registered. Each receives a unique player ID and initial tournament state.

6.2.1 Initial Player State

- Zero tournament points.
- Equal starting coins.
- Initial roster defined by starting rules.

- Nine-slot bench.
- Empty or predefined deployment configuration.
- Access to the first planning-phase shop.

6.2.2 Tournament Initialization

- Register eight players.
- Initialize standings.
- Assign starting resources.
- Generate initial shop offers.
- Create opening round and pairings.
- Begin planning phase.

6.3 Tournament Rounds

Each round follows: **Planning - Formation Lock - Match Pairing - Simultaneous Battle - Match Scoring - Standings Update - Elimination Check**.

6.3.1 Planning Phase

Players receive income, manage shop and bench, deploy characters, and configure movesets. Planning ends on formation lock or configured timer expiration.

6.3.2 Battle Phase

Each player faces one opponent across two simultaneous arenas. The match continues until both resolve.

6.3.3 Results Phase

Results, points, and standings are recorded. At elimination checkpoints, the lowest-ranked players are removed before the next round.

6.4 Match Structure

Arena A	Arena B
Player A offense vs Player B defense	Player B offense vs Player A defense

Both arenas use the same deterministic movement, tagging, and resolution rules.

6.4.1 Match Independence

Each arena maintains its own simulation. Events in one arena do not directly change unit behavior in the other, but both results contribute to match score.

6.4.2 Match Completion

A match finishes only after both arena outcomes are recorded. No final match points are awarded while an arena remains unresolved.

6.5 Arena Victory Conditions

6.5.1 Offensive Victory

Offense wins when at least one runner reaches row 7 and returns to row 0 without being tagged.

6.5.2 Defensive Victory

Defense wins when opposing runners fail to complete a valid round trip under the arena rules. Eliminating all runners before a round trip is a defensive win.

6.5.3 Arena Timeout

Provisional MVP rule: a timeout without a completed round trip awards the arena to the defender. Exact time limit remains unconfirmed.

6.6 Match Scoring

Each arena awards one point to its winner; exactly two points are distributed across the match.

Player A result	Player B result	Match score
Wins offense and defense	Loses both	2-0
Wins one, loses one	Wins one, loses one	1-1
Loses both	Wins offense and defense	0-2

6.6.1 Two-Arena Sweep

A 2-0 sweep is the strongest match outcome and qualifies for the applicable coin bonus.

6.6.2 Split Result

A 1-1 result awards one tournament point to each player.

6.6.3 Match Loss

A 0-2 result awards zero tournament points to the losing player.

6.7 Tournament Points

Match result	Points earned
2-0	2
1-1	1
0-2	0

Tournament points accumulate across rounds and do not reset at elimination stages. Total tournament points equal the sum of arena victories.

6.7.1 Points Calculation

Tournament Points = Sum of Arena Victories. Each arena contributes zero or one point.

6.7.2 Scoring Integrity

Only authoritative arena results may award points, once per completed match. Duplicate submissions must not increase scores.

6.8 Matchmaking System

Each active player receives exactly one opponent per round.

6.8.1 Pairing Requirements

- Only active players are eligible.
- At most one match per player per round.
- Exactly two players per match.
- Every active player receives a pairing.
- Pairings are reproducible from tournament state.

6.8.2 Opening Round

Eight players form four matches. Initial pairings may use a recorded random seed.

6.8.3 Subsequent Rounds

A consistent algorithm is required. Standings-based pairing with repeat-opponent avoidance is recommended, but not finalized.

6.8.4 Even Player Counts

Stages contain 8, 6, 4, or 2 players, so ordinary tournament play requires no byes.

6.9 Standings System

Standings update after each completed round and retain both active and eliminated participants.

6.9.1 Standings Data

Field	Description
Player ID / name	Unique identifier and display name
Tournament points	Accumulated arena victories
Matches played	Completed match count
Arena wins / losses	Overall arena performance
Successful round trips	Valid runner completions
Average completion time	Mean valid round-trip duration
Elimination status	Active or eliminated
Current rank	Position in standings

6.9.2 Ranking Order

Primary rank criterion is total tournament points. Ties are resolved by configured secondary statistics.

6.10 Tiebreaker Rules

Priority	Criterion	Preferred
1	Tournament points	Higher
2	Successful round trips	Higher
3	Average round-trip time	Lower
4	Deterministic final fallback	To be defined

6.10.1 Proposed Ranking Priority

Use the criteria in the table above. A seeded initial order is a possible final fallback but remains provisional.

6.10.2 Completion Time Handling

Calculate average time only from valid round trips. Players without successful completions must not receive an artificially favorable average.

6.10.3 Tiebreaker Consistency

Statistics come from authoritative simulation records, not rendering, network latency, or local device speed.

6.11 Elimination System

Stage	Before	Eliminated	Remaining
First	8	2	6
Second	6	2	4
Third	4	2	2
Championship	2	1	1

6.11.1 Elimination Progression

The fixed progression is 8 to 6 to 4 to 2 to 1.

6.11.2 Elimination Procedure

- Complete all current matches.
- Finalize points and tiebreaker statistics.
- Sort participants by ranking rules.
- Eliminate required bottom-ranked players.
- Mark eliminated players inactive.
- Update standings and advance survivors.

6.11.3 Eliminated Players

Eliminated players cannot join subsequent matches. Their final placement and statistics remain visible; their roster and economy cease active participation.

6.12 Tournament Stage Scheduling

The number of rounds between elimination checkpoints must be explicitly configured.

6.12.1 Stage Configuration

- Stage ID and active-player count.
- Number of rounds in stage.
- Elimination checkpoint and number eliminated.
- Stage-specific restrictions.

6.12.2 MVP Scheduling Requirement

All participants follow the same finalized schedule. **Open:** exact round counts between 8-, 6-, 4-, and 2-player stages.

6.13 Championship Stage

The final two surviving players compete for the championship.

6.13.1 Championship Participants

The two highest-ranked survivors retain their rosters and upgrades.

6.13.2 Championship Shop Restriction

The shop is disabled during the established championship rematch: no purchases or rerolls. Existing units remain available, with any formation adjustments subject to championship rules.

6.13.3 Championship Resolution

A 2-0 championship result produces a clear winner. A 1-1 result requires an explicit rematch or tiebreaker rule, still to be finalized.

6.14 Championship Rematch

The rematch uses existing rosters and the same deterministic dual-arena rules.

6.14.1 Rematch Preparation

Finalists may review prior results and adjust formations and movesets if permitted; no shop purchases or rerolls.

6.14.2 Rematch Execution

No special movement, tagging, or scoring rules are introduced unless explicitly documented.

6.14.3 Final Winner Determination

Finalized championship rules must guarantee one winner without permanent unresolved ties.

6.15 Match Results Screen

After a match, show both arena outcomes, match score, points, economic rewards, and performance statistics.

6.15.1 Required Results Information

- Both player names and each arena outcome.
- Final match score and tournament points earned.
- Applicable coin rewards.

- Round-trip statistics.
- Updated standings or standings access.
- Replay access when supported.

6.15.2 Results Confirmation

Players may review results while other matches finish. The next round begins only after all required outcomes are finalized.

6.16 Tournament Standings Interface

The standings screen displays rank, player, points, and active/eliminated status, with relevant tiebreaker details. Players should understand their position and proximity to elimination.

Rank	Player	Points	Status
1	Player A	8	Active
2	Player B	7	Active
3	Player C	6	Active
4	Player D	5	Active
5	Player E	4	Active
6	Player F	3	Active
7	Player G	2	Out
8	Player H	1	Out

Standings shown are illustrative, not actual results.

6.17 Tournament State Management

The tournament maintains authoritative records of participants, pairings, results, standings, and eliminations.

6.17.1 Tournament States

Waiting for Players - Initializing Tournament - Planning - Battle - Results - Standings - Elimination Check - Championship - Tournament Complete.

6.17.2 State Transition Requirements

Results require completed arena outcomes; elimination requires finalized round matches; championship requires exactly two finalists.

6.18 Multiplayer and Synchronization Requirements

All players must receive consistent authoritative match results.

6.18.1 Authoritative Match Data

- Player IDs and locked formations.
- Character identities, star levels, and anchors.

- Equipped card sequences and initial simulation state.
- Arena outcomes, match score, and round-trip statistics.
- Tournament points awarded.

6.18.2 Synchronization Principles

Animation timing cannot determine results. Network authority and synchronization design are defined in Section 9.

6.18.3 Disconnect and Incomplete Match Handling

A consistent policy is required for disconnects or missing formations: last valid formation, automatic lock, or forfeit are possible, but no penalty is finalized.

6.19 Tournament Balance Guidelines

- 2-0 wins provide appropriate competitive advantage.
- 1-1 results permit meaningful progression.
- Tiebreakers distinguish equal-ranked players.
- Elimination checkpoints have suitable pacing.
- Economy permits recovery from early losses.
- Repeat pairings do not create unfair advantages.
- Offense and defense remain equally relevant.
- Championship produces a clear winner.
- Shop-disabled rematch remains strategically meaningful.
- Total tournament fits target session duration.

6.20 MVP Acceptance Criteria

- Exactly eight entrants and valid active-player pairings.
- Two simultaneous arenas per match.
- Authoritative arena outcomes and 2-0 / 1-1 / 0-2 scores.
- Correct tournament point awards and standings updates.
- Deterministic tiebreaker ranking.
- Elimination through 8 - 6 - 4 - 2.
- Eliminated players excluded from future matches.
- Two finalists and one eventual champion.
- Championship shop restriction enforced.
- Results and final standings displayed.
- Validated tournament state transitions.
- No duplicate scoring or invalid elimination.

Section 6 - Items Requiring Confirmation

Design item	Status
Tournament participants	Confirmed: 8
Elimination progression	Confirmed: 8 - 6 - 4 - 2 - 1
Arenas per match	Confirmed: 2
Match scoring	Established: 2-0, 1-1, 0-2
Tournament points	Established: 1 per arena win
2-0 economic bonus	Confirmed; amount pending
Round-trip tiebreaker	Established
Average completion-time tiebreaker	Established
Rounds between eliminations	To be confirmed
Matchmaking algorithm	To be confirmed
Arena time limit	To be confirmed
Timeout outcome	Provisional: defender wins
Final ranking fallback	To be confirmed
Championship rematch	Established
Championship shop	Confirmed: disabled
Championship 1-1 resolution	To be confirmed
Disconnect / forfeit handling	To be confirmed

Draft note: unresolved values and provisional rules must be finalized before implementation.